

VryfID Webhook: Getwaitlist → Mailchimp

A free serverless webhook that syncs new Getwaitlist signups to Mailchimp with full merge field support, including referral data.

What this does

```
Renter signs up on landing page
↓
Getwaitlist sends day-0 welcome email (handled by Getwaitlist)
↓
Getwaitlist webhook → this serverless function → Mailchimp
↓
Subscriber added to Mailchimp with: FNAME, LNAME, PRIORITY, REFLINK, REFCOUNT,
SOURCE
↓
Mailchimp Customer Journey takes over (day 3+ emails)
```

Setup (15 minutes)

Step 1: Gather your Mailchimp credentials

You need 3 things from Mailchimp:

1. **API Key** — Mailchimp → click your profile (bottom left) → Profile → Extras → API Keys → "Create A Key"
2. **Server Prefix** — log in to Mailchimp, look at your URL:
`https://us12.admin.mailchimp.com` → the prefix is `us12`
3. **Audience ID** — Audience → Settings → "Audience name and defaults" → scroll down to find "Audience ID" (looks like `a1b2c3d4e5`)

Step 2: Set up Mailchimp custom merge fields

In Mailchimp: Audience → Settings → "Audience fields and */MERGE/* tags"

Add these fields (the **tag name** is what matters — must match exactly):

Field Name	Tag Name	Type
Priority	PRIORITY	Number
Referral Link	REFLINK	Text
Referrals Made	REFCOUNT	Number
Source	SOURCE	Text

(FNAME and LNAME come standard with every audience.)

Step 3: Deploy this function to Vercel

1. Push this folder to a GitHub repo (or use Vercel CLI to deploy directly)
2. Go to vercel.com/new and import the repo
3. During the import, click "Environment Variables" and add:

Name	Value
MAILCHIMP_API_KEY	(from Step 1)
MAILCHIMP_SERVER_PREFIX	(from Step 1, e.g., us12)
MAILCHIMP_AUDIENCE_ID	(from Step 1)
MAILCHIMP_TAG	the-exchange-waitlist
WEBHOOK_SECRET	(a long random string — generate with <code>openssl rand -hex 32</code> in your terminal)

4. Click Deploy
5. Once deployed, your webhook URL will be: `https://your-project-name.vercel.app/api/getwaitlist-to-mailchimp?secret=YOUR_WEBHOOK_SECRET`

Step 4: Configure Getwaitlist to call your webhook

1. Go to Getwaitlist Dashboard → your waitlist → **Automations** tab
2. Find the "Webhooks" section
3. Add a new webhook with:
 - **Event:** New Signup

- **URL:** `https://your-project-name.vercel.app/api/getwaitlist-to-mailchimp?secret=YOUR_WEBHOOK_SECRET`
- **Method:** POST

4. Save

Step 5: Test end-to-end

1. Sign up on your landing page with a real email you control
2. Within 1 minute, you should:
 - Receive the Getwaitlist welcome email
 - See your contact appear in Mailchimp (Audience → All contacts)
 - See the contact tagged `the-exchange-waitlist`
 - See merge fields populated (FNAME, PRIORITY, REFLINK, etc.)
3. Check Vercel function logs (Vercel dashboard → your project → Functions → Logs) to see the webhook firing

Step 6: Build the Mailchimp Customer Journey

In Mailchimp: Automations → Customer Journeys → Create new

- **Starting point:** "Tag added" → `the-exchange-waitlist`
- **First step:** Wait 3 days (critical — prevents overlap with Getwaitlist welcome)
- **Second step:** Send Day 3 email
- Continue with day 7, 14, etc.

In email templates, use these merge tags:

- `*|FNAME|*` — first name
- `*|PRIORITY|*` — their position in line
- `*|REFLINK|*` — their referral link
- `*|REFCOUNT|*` — number of referrals so far

Troubleshooting

Mailchimp returns 400 "Member Exists" — the function uses PUT to `/members/{hash}` which is upsert (create or update), so this shouldn't happen. If it does, check the audience ID is correct.

Webhook never fires — verify the URL in Getwaitlist matches exactly (including the `?secret=` query param). Check Vercel function logs for incoming requests.

Webhook fires but Mailchimp doesn't update — check Vercel logs for the Mailchimp error response. Most common: wrong server prefix or invalid audience ID.

Tags not appearing — tags are added via a separate API call after the subscriber is created. Check Vercel logs to see if the tag call succeeded.

Cost

- **Vercel Hobby plan:** Free (1M function invocations/month — you'd need 33,000 signups/day to exceed)
- **Mailchimp:** Free up to 500 contacts. Beyond that, paid plans start around \$13/mo
- **Getwaitlist:** Free tier supports webhooks (verify your plan)

Files

- `api/getwaitlist-to-mailchimp.js` — the webhook function
- `package.json` — Node config
- `.env.example` — environment variables reference